HEXLEY CHEMICALS

Statement Guide: Fire Precautions

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1. What this guide covers

This guide covers fire precautions for hot work: combustible materials cleared from around the work, the fire watch during the work and after it, extinguishers and fire blankets, drains sealed, and sparks contained. They appear in method statements and task risk assessments for hot work.

The guide is used by the Permit Coordinator or Area Authority who opens a review - the reviewer in this guide - and by the Area Authority who decides it. Whether a requirement is met is a separate question, settled by the request and its permit type's own standard. This guide is about what the documents show: the tools flag only a gas reading that differs from the request's, as the Permit Rules set out, and every other check here is the reviewer's own.

2. How it shows up in a statement

A sentence of this kind usually says one of these:

- combustible materials cleared to a distance in metres around the work
- a fire watch kept for a number of minutes after the work ends
- extinguishers or a fire blanket at the work area
- drains and gullies near the work covered or sealed
- welding screens or spark containment sheets

3. What the reviewer checks

These are the checks the reviewer makes, in this order:

1 Find the request's clearance and fire watch for hot work.
2 Read each sentence of this kind for a clearance in metres and a fire watch in minutes.
3 Compare a stated clearance and fire watch with the request's.
4 Note a sentence giving a shorter clearance or fire watch than the request.
5 Check extinguishers are at the work area and the drains nearby are sealed.

4. Requirements it bears on

Fire precautions bear on the combustibles cleared and fire watch requirements of the hot work standard.

5. When the statement and the request disagree

When a statement gives another clearance or fire watch than the request, the reviewer notes it for the Area Authority and keeps the request's answers, which still decide the requirements.

6. What to ask the requester for

Ask the performing authority for the clearance measured around the work, the fire watch arrangements and how long the fire watch stays after the work ends, and where the extinguishers are.

7. Telling it apart

Keeping fire away from the work is fire precautions; keeping the work area tidy and taking waste away is housekeeping and waste, which the Housekeeping and Waste guide covers. "Everything that can burn is moved back from the work point" is a fire precaution; "oily rags are put in the metal bin" is housekeeping, though both keep fuel away from the work.